GRADUATE STUDENT TEACHING ORIENTATION

EARLY EDUCATION - GRADES PK-4
SECONDARY EDUCATION - GRADES 7-12
SPECIAL EDUCATION - GRADES PK-12

A Guide for Student Teachers, Cooperating/Mentor Teachers, and University Supervisors

Revised December 2025



Gwynedd Mercy University

College of Arts, Sciences, & Professional Studies

GMercyU – Mission/Vision/Values

- **Gwynedd Mercy University's Mission Statement -** Gwynedd Mercy is a Catholic University rooted in the tradition of the Sisters of Mercy. Our learning community prepares students for successful careers and meaningful lives in a global society.
- **Gwynedd Mercy University's Core Values**
  - Integrity in Word and Deed
  - Respect for the Dignity of Each Person
  - Service to Society
  - Social Justice in a Diverse World (special focus: Earth, Immigration, Racism, Non-Violence, Women)
- **At Gwynedd Mercy University, We Believe That:**
  - Education is a life-long process that enriches the intellectual, moral, and spiritual life of the individual and prepares him/her for an active role in society.
  - The cultivation of compassion, intellectual inquiry, dedication to truth, mercy, and justice is essential in improving the human condition.
  - Education is a process of transforming oneself and society.
  - Individual attention in a caring environment promotes learning.

Core Principles of Student Teaching and Program Learning Outcomes

The Master Teacher program supports the mission of Gwynedd Mercy University in three ways:

- The program continues the tradition of creating a learning community within the field of Education recognizing the core values of compassion, integrity, valuing of diversity, and recognition of the dignity of each person.
- Inquiry and dialogue are hallmarks of the program where students are encouraged to participate in their education process through critical questioning, personal research, and the development of a collaborative process.
- The program focuses on developing competent professionals who strive to participate in the teaching/learning process while upholding and advancing ethical, academic, and organizational standards.

Program Learning Outcomes

1. Apply theoretical and practical knowledge in support of your professional practice.
2. Utilize educational research and develop your own research interests and agenda.
3. Examine and critique the economic, political, cultural, historical, and social influences that impact education in the United States.
4. Apply policies, statutes, and rules established by state and local agencies relating to judicious application of disciplinary methods and behavioral procedures.
5. Identify and use instructional methods and curricula that are appropriate and effective in meeting the needs of individual learners.

Key Terms and People

- **Student Teacher -** A teacher candidate engaged in student teaching in a school or agency.
- **Cooperating Teacher -** The professional teacher with whom the field experience student is working. The teacher is a or agency employee who guides and mentors, prospective teachers within an actual classroom. Cooperating teachers must: have a **minimum of three years of satisfactory teaching experience; hold a Level II PA certificate; have satisfactory or better evaluations**. Cooperating teachers receive a voucher with which to take a free, three credit course through our School of Graduate and Professional Studies, as compensation for their service.
- **Mentor Teacher -** The professional teacher in the same field experience or administrative role. The mentor is a school or district employee with leadership skills, has outstanding work performance, and has mentor training or has trained other pre-service or induction teachers. Mentor teachers must have a **minimum of three years of above satisfactory teaching experience; hold a Level II PA certificate; have above satisfactory or better evaluations.**
- **University Supervisor -** A university employee responsible to mentor the field placement student, to observe and evaluate the student, and collaborate with the cooperating/mentor teacher.
- **Certification and Placement Specialist -** The university staff member who is responsible for all aspects of the student teaching experience and certification application process after program completion. (Dr. Patrick McAleer)
- **EDU565/SPE 565: Student Teaching & Professional Seminar -** This fifteen-week course provides an overview of the student teaching handbook and opportunities to apply knowledge of the Danielson Framework for authentic classroom situations. Students will have the opportunity to share ideas directly relevant to the student teaching process with their peers. Student teachers will explore how to search for and obtain a teaching position. Weekly discussions will facilitate collaboration with student teaching colleagues to further enhance the student teaching experience.
- **OTHER IMPORTANT TERMS** – please review the handbook (glossary).

Requirements for Entrance to Student Teaching Field Placement

A. In order to submit an application for student teaching, the student must:

- Meet with his/her advisor to review the academic plan and ensure that all coursework is successfully completed
- Have completed all required field placement experiences
- Have obtained a GPA of at least 3.0
- Not have more than one C+ on his/her transcript
- Have a B or better in the following courses:
  - PreK-4: EDU506, EDU507, EDU511, EDU512, EDU580, EDU581
  - Secondary: EDU508, EDU580, EDU581, EDU591

B. After meeting with his/her advisor and meeting the requirements as shown, the student teaching candidate will submit an application to his/her advisor:

- Fall student teaching placement **by February 1st**
- Spring student teaching placement **by August 1st**.

C. Attached to the application, the student teaching candidate will submit:

- PA State Criminal Record Check (Act 34)
- Child Abuse History Clearance (Act 151)
- Federal FBI Criminal History Record (Act 114)
- TB Test Results/Negative (**must be dated within 90 days of starting student teaching placement**)
- PDE 6004 Form/Arrest-Conviction Form
- Transcripts - Undergraduate and Graduate
- Resume
- Level II Content Area Praxis Scores (Secondary Education candidates ONLY)
- Audit form and supporting documentation (some Secondary certification candidates)

Clearances must be current. The date of issue must be valid for one year. With the added one year, the clearances must not expire before the start of the student teaching date. A placement request cannot be submitted to a school district without all current clearances and TB test results.

Design of the Student Teaching Experience

Pennsylvania Department of Education Definition of Student Teaching:

- *Student teaching is defined as a set of organized and carefully planned classroom teaching experiences required of all candidates in a preparation program. Student teachers are assigned to one or more classrooms, closely supervised and mentored by a certified teacher, the cooperating teacher, who provides regular feedback to the student on his or her classroom teaching performance. General supervision of student teachers is provided by a university or college professional educator* (The Framework for K-12 Program Guidelines, 2016, p. 21).

PDE Student Teaching Supervision Requirements:

- *Must be supervised by faculty with knowledge and experience in the area of certification and a cooperating teacher with appropriate professional educator certification (3 years satisfactory certified teaching experience on the appropriate certificate and 1 year certified experience in the specific placement) who is trained by the preparation program faculty* **(22 Pa. Code Section 354.25(f))** (The Framework for K-12 Program Guidelines, 2016, p. 21).

Design of the Student Teaching Experience

Student teachers must:

- Follow the calendar and the hours of the professional teacher in the school where they are placed.
- Attend school each day that school is in session, throughout the student teaching experience.
- The total number of weeks in a student teaching placement is **15 weeks**.
- Conduct themselves as members of the profession.
- Know and use the ethical guidelines and professional standards related to theories of practice.
- They will have opportunities to collaborate with other professionals and become informed advocates for sound educational practices and policies.

Required Products of Student Teaching – Student Teaching Portfolio

1. **Reflection Journal** - Due to your supervisor weekly, but must be available any time they would like to read them.
   - Your observations, discoveries, learnings, "ah-ha" moments, things that were successful and those that were not, (and why/why not).
   - Collection of strategies/techniques observed and effectively implemented that you plan to cement into your teaching repertoire.
   - Wonderings about aspects of curriculum, instruction, and assessment that you are exploring; want to continue observing and trying out; and want to come to conclusions about over time.
   - Base reflections upon the domains of Charlotte Danielson's Framework for Teaching - planning and preparation; classroom environment; instructional delivery; and professionalism. Analyze areas of success and areas for professional growth and improvement.

2. **Letter of Introduction to the Guardians of the Students** - Your university supervisor must approve your letter first, then it may be distributed to families

3. **Lesson Plans**
   - The Gwynedd Mercy University Lesson Planning Framework is the required template (found in the ST handbook; also located on the Student Portal in the Student Teaching folder).
   - You must utilize this template each time your supervisor has a scheduled observation; you must send the appropriate lesson plan and any accompanying documentation to your supervisor **at least two days in advance** of the observation.
   - All lesson plans must be approved and signed off on by your cooperating/mentor teacher. He/she may require changes to your lesson plan prior to your instruction.
   - All related materials for the lesson should accompany the lesson plan.

Professionalism in Student Teaching Placement

- **Attendance and punctuality are required every day.** Absences, late arrivals, or early departures are not acceptable during student teaching. In an extreme emergency, the student must:
  - Obtain approval to be absent from the Certification and Placement Specialist
  - Inform your cooperating/mentor teacher, university supervisor, and seminar professor
  - Work with your university supervisor to make up the absence
- **Without approval by the Certification and Placement Specialist, an absence, lateness, or early departure may result in a negative impact on your final grade, removal from student teaching and an inability to become certified.**
- **Extended or repeated absence for medical/emergency reasons**: **Immediately** inform your Cooperating/Mentor Teacher and school administrator at your placement, as well as your University Supervisor, and the Certification and Placement Specialist. Extended time missed due to medical reasons or other emergent circumstances may need to be made up at the end of the student teaching semester.

Professionalism in Student Teaching Placement

- You must follow the **morning arrival** and **afternoon departure** times of the cooperating/mentor teacher in the placement school as specified in the district's teacher contract/agreement. When you contact your cooperating/ mentor teacher, inquire about teacher hours so you know at what time to arrive on your first day of school.
- Should you wish to arrive early or remain after hours for purposes of planning/preparation or special events/activities, you may do so if your cooperating/mentor teacher and principal permit you to be in the building before/after the teacher workday.
- Attending a Back-To-School-Night, Open House, PTA meeting, a Faculty Meeting, or other special event will certainly fortify your understanding of many of the aspects involved in working as a professional teacher. While you are not required to attend any activities beyond the hours of the contracted teacher work day, such experiences will help you to grow professionally.
- In addition to your field placement, **attendance and participation in your seminar, with its assignments and tasks, are requirements and are factored into your final student teaching grade.**
- **NOTE: a student teacher's placement may be terminated by the University and/or the placement for failure to meet program expectations or violation of school district policies/rules; removal from the placement may result in a failing grade for student teaching.**

Dress Code Policy for Student Teaching Experier

- Expectation = professional dress attire. Examples include:
  - dress shirt/blouse; tie; dress slacks (worn at the waist); dress/skirt (professional length); dress shoes.
  - **No** sweats, jeans, sneakers, or casual wear. No skin should be showing, especially when reaching over your head. Excessive jewelry should be avoided. Visible tattoos should be covered where possible.
- **All students must meet or exceed the dress code of the local school/district. If the local district or school is more casual than these guidelines, these guidelines supersede them. If the district or school is more formal, the local guidelines supersede these.**

Student Teacher Assessment and Grading Protocol

Your final grade for student teaching will be determined with input from your cooperating/mentor teacher, university supervisor, seminar professor, and the Certification and Placement Specialist. The cooperating/mentor teacher and university supervisor will utilize a standard observation form, using the Danielson Framework, when conducting student teaching observations. Feedback will be given to the student teacher regarding his/her level of proficiency within each of the four domains.

- The areas of performance on which the student teacher is assessed are found within the four domains of the PDE-430. The four domains of professional knowledge and practice are:
  - **Planning and Preparation**
  - **Classroom Environment**
  - **Instructional Delivery**
  - **Professional Responsibilities**

The final evaluation and rating of the supervisor, as per the PDE-430 evaluation forms, will constitute a large part of the grade determination.

Student Teacher Assessment and Grading Protocol

The assessment ratings are **Exemplary**, **Expected**, **Emergent**, and **Unsatisfactory**.

- **Exemplary –** instructional behaviors/abilities in the four domains **far exceed expectations**. The student teacher **consistently** and **thoroughly**, performs at a very high level and **far exceeds expectations** in all aspects of implementing the four domains.
- **Expected** – instructional behaviors/abilities ***do not exceed expectations but meet them at a commonly expected level***. The student teacher ***usually*** and ***extensively*** **performs at a high level** in all aspects of implementing the four domains.
- **Emergent** – instructional behaviors/abilities **d*o not exceed expectations but are emergent***. The student teacher ***sometimes*** and ***adequately*** **performs at a level that meets the criteria** in all aspects of implementing the four domains.
- **Unsatisfactory** – instructional behaviors/abilities demonstrate that they are ***not meeting expectations*** on a daily basis. The language which signifies **Unsatisfactory** performance is, ***rarely*** **or** ***never*** **and** ***inappropriately*** **or** ***superficially*****.** When a student is implementing teaching and learning activities but is **rarely** or **never**, or **inappropriately** or **superficially** meeting the criteria for professional knowledge and practice within the four domains, they will receive a rating of Unsatisfactory.

Student Teacher Assessment and Grading Protocol

- **Fail** – A grade of **F** will be earned by a student teacher who is withdrawn from the student teaching field experience at the request of the school administrator. The school administrator will have reached the decision to request removal of the student teacher in collaboration with the cooperating/mentor teacher and the supervisor. The student may be permitted to repeat the student teaching experience if indicated by the supervisor, the student advisor, and the Certification and Placement Specialist, and approved by the Associate Dean of Academics or the Dean of the College of Arts, Sciences, & Professional Studies.
- If a student teacher fails student teaching, a grade of **F** is shown on the student transcript and is calculated into the quality grade-point-average.

Grading Scale

- A = 93 – 100
- A - = 90 – 92
- B + = 87 – 89
- B = 83 – 86
- B - = 80 – 82
- C + = 77 – 79
- C = 73 - 76
- C - = 70 – 72
- D + = 67 – 69
- D = 63 – 66
- D - = 60 – 62
- F = below 60

Criteria for Evaluating and Grading Student Teachers

The student teaching field placement experience will be evaluated and graded, to a large extent, according to the student's ability to demonstrate proficiency associated with the following components of professional practice and the following, bulleted descriptors, or indicators of performance.

- **Planning and Preparation** – Student teachers/candidates must demonstrate thorough knowledge of content and pedagogical skills in planning and preparation. Student teachers will make plans and set goals based on the content to be taught/learned, their knowledge of assigned students and instructional content. Student teachers'/candidates' performance should appropriately demonstrate:
  - Knowledge of content
  - Knowledge of pedagogy
  - Knowledge of Pennsylvania's K-12 Academic Standards
  - Knowledge of students and how to use this knowledge to impart instruction
  - Use of resources, materials, or technology available through the school or district
  - Instructional goals that show a recognizable sequence with adaptations for individual student needs
  - Assessments of student learning aligned to the instructional goals and adapted as required for student needs
  - Use of educational, psychological principles/theories in the construction of lesson plans and setting instructional goals.
- **Classroom Environment** – Student teachers/candidates must establish and maintain a purposeful and equitable environment for learning, in which students feel safe, valued, and respected, by instituting routines and setting clear expectations for student behavior.
  Student teachers'/candidates' performance should appropriately demonstrate:
  - Expectations for student achievement with value placed on the quality of student work
  - Attention to equitable learning opportunities for students
  - Appropriate interactions between teacher and students and among students
  - Effective classroom routines and procedures resulting in little or no loss of instructional time
  - Clear standards of conduct and effective management of student behavior
  - Appropriate attention is given to safety in the classroom to the extent that it is under the control of the student teacher
  - Ability to establish and maintain rapport with students

Criteria for Evaluating and Grading Student Teachers

- **Instruction** – Student teachers/candidates, thorough knowledge of content, pedagogy, and skill in delivering instruction, engage students in learning by using a variety of instructional strategies. Student teachers'/candidates' performance should appropriately demonstrate:
  - Use of knowledge of content and pedagogical theory through his/her instructional delivery
  - Instructional goals reflecting Pennsylvania K-12 Academic Standards
  - Communication of procedures and clear explanation of the content
  - Use of instructional goals that show a recognizable sequence, clear student expectations, and adaptations for individual student needs
  - Use of questioning/discussion strategies that encourage many students to participate
  - Engagement of students in learning; the adequate pacing of engagement of students in learning; and adequate pacing of instruction
  - Feedback to students on their learning
  - Use of informal and formal assessments to meet learning goals and to monitor student learning
  - Flexibility and responsiveness in meeting the learning needs of students
  - Integration of disciplines within the educational curriculum

- **Professional Responsibilities** – Student teacher/candidates demonstrate qualities that characterize a professional person in aspects that occur in and beyond the classroom building. Student teachers'/candidates' performance should appropriately demonstrate:
  - Knowledge of school and district procedures and regulations related to attendance, punctuality and the like
  - Knowledge of school or district requirements for maintaining accurate records and communicating with families
  - Knowledge of school and district events
  - Knowledge of district or college's professional growth/development opportunities
  - Integrity and ethical behavior, professional conduct as stated in the Pennsylvania Code of Professional Practice and Conduct for Educators; and local, state, and federal laws and regulations
  - Effective communication, both oral and written with students, colleagues, paraprofessionals, related service personnel, and administrators
  - Ability to cultivate professional relationships with school colleagues
  - Knowledge of Commonwealth requirements for continuing professional development and licensure

Responsibilities of Cooperating/Mentor Teachers

The cooperating/mentor teacher:

- must be willing to devote the time necessary to assist in the proper training of a new teacher.
- provides a model of effective teaching techniques, and processes and procedures, through implementation of exemplary lessons and accompanying assessment activities.
- models best practices (instruction, curriculum, and assessment) and provides on-going feedback to the student teacher. This feedback highlights student teacher behaviors which support the achievement and success of the students and highlights behaviors utilized by the student teacher which are not successfully supporting learners.
- guides the student teacher to modify and adapt instructional behaviors, so that lesson plans and implementations are successful.
- is critical in the development of pre-service teachers.

Exemplary cooperating/mentor teachers produce exemplary student teachers who go on to be extraordinary teachers.

Responsibilities of Cooperating/Mentor Teachers

The responsibilities of the cooperating/mentor teacher include:

- Providing the student teacher with a desk, chair, and secure place for belongings.
- Providing opportunities for the student teacher to observe exemplary teaching and learning activities.
- Assisting the student teacher in assimilating the experiences into correctly structured teaching/learning activities with accompanying strategies and procedures, i.e., long and short range planning and subsequent instruction and assessment.
- Helping the student teacher gain understanding and practice regarding other aspects of school: classroom management techniques/systems; non-instructional duties and activities; professional responsibilities; faculty, administration, and rapport with families.
- Continuously evaluating the student teacher's assigned tasks and providing honest feedback about the successes and the areas in need of improvement.
- Scheduling a weekly conference time to evaluate progress and plan for subsequent experiences.
- Utilizing the Communication Log biweekly to inform the Supervisor or Certification and Placement Specialist of any concerns. If there are no concerns, the forms can all be submitted to the Certification and Placement Specialist at the end-of-semester. If concerns exist, contact the Certification and Placement Specialist immediately.
- Utilizing the Lesson Observation Form included in this Handbook to assess the student for a Mid-Term and Final report.
- Utilizing the Lesson Observation Form two other times, as formal observations, and turn all 4 forms into the Certification and Placement Specialist, at the conclusion of the placement. If problems are noted, contact and turn in Lesson Observation Forms immediately to the Certification and Placement Specialist in order to address concerns prior to the end of the semester.
- Complete Cooperating/Mentor Teacher Exit Survey and return to the Certification and Placement Specialist. Documents must be scanned and sent as a PDF file to the Certification and Placement Specialist.

Cooperating Teacher and Student Teacher Roadmap

GMERCYU
Gwynedd Mercy University

Student Teaching Responsibilities (Recommended Fifteen-Week Schedule)

- **Week 1**
  - Become acquainted with all procedures including classroom management and instructional strategies
  - Write a letter of introduction with approval of classroom teacher and principal
  - Request permission of the principal and parents for one videotaped session of your teaching
  - Begin personal reflection journal
  - Review curriculum guides, textbooks, manuals, etc.
  - Learn school and classroom behavior expectations, routines, and emergency procedures
  - Observe teacher for classroom management and instructional strategies
  - Become familiar with technology resources, professional resources, and library materials
- **Week 2**
  - Continue to observe teacher and, if appropriate, other teachers (recommendation: 20 hours of total observations by week 2)
  - Assist with individual students
  - Assist with routine activities such as attendance, homeroom, supervision of lunch, escorting students to class, hall monitoring, bus duty
  - Co-plan and co-teach a minimum of one and a maximum of three classes a day
  - Discuss the teaching and learning process with the classroom teacher
  - Develop instructional materials to assist the classroom teacher
  - Participate in professional activities, faculty meetings, SAP, IEP meetings

Cooperating Teacher and Student Teacher Roadmap

- **Weeks 3-5**
  - Continue to observe classroom teacher and other teachers if appropriate
  - Assume total responsibility for routine activities such as attendance, homeroom, supervision
  - Plan and implement three lessons/classes per day
  - Keep lesson plans in working portfolio
  - Reflect on the teaching and learning process in your journal
  - Confer with cooperating teacher on a regular basis
  - Develop instructional materials as appropriate
  - Develop plan to assume full instructional responsibilities including planning, teaching, and evaluating the learning process
  - Meet to discuss mid-term evaluation form by the end of Week 4
  - Participate in professional development activities

- **Weeks 6-13**
  - Plan and implement all instructional responsibilities planned with the teacher
  - Schedule with the cooperating teacher three weeks of full instructional responsibility
  - Keep lesson plans organized in working portfolio
  - Complete bulletin boards and learning center requirements
  - Continue journal reflections
  - Continue professional development activities
  - Ask principal to come in and observe a lesson
  - Assist in planning IEP (Special Education only)

- **Weeks 14-15**
  - Continue to plan and teach agreed upon number of classes/lessons during phase-out period
  - Complete self-evaluation
  - Review and discuss final evaluations with classroom teacher and supervisor
  - Return all materials to classroom teacher
  - Finish professional development activities
  - Plan appropriate thank you and departing activities for students, teacher, and principal
  - Request letter of recommendation

Cooperating/Mentor Teacher Forms

- Lesson Observation Form
- Communication Log re: Student Teachers
- Cooperating/Mentor Teacher Exit Survey

University Supervisors - Responsibilities

The University Supervisor is assigned to students by the Certification and Placement Specialist. The supervisor serves as a mentor to the student teacher and a liaison between the University and the placement school or agency, and the cooperating/mentor teacher. Supervisors visit the student teacher for observations of lessons, providing feedback and recommendations of these evaluations. They also offer regular verbal/written feedback and guidance to student teachers and cooperating teachers/mentors.

The responsibilities of the University Supervisor include:

- visiting/observing the student teacher six times, including one video observation. **Observations must be made in weeks 3, 5, 7, 10, 12 (video), and 13.** Observations are required to be a minimum of 45 minutes in duration. Note (PK or K only): the duration of a lesson might be only about 15-20 minutes in duration; as such, an additional lesson or activity should be observed in order to see the student teacher truly in action for a full 45 minute window.
- receiving and reviewing lesson plans before each observation.
- discussing concerns regarding lesson plans and providing your student time to make adjustments based on your feedback before lesson implementation.
- providing feedback following each observation. Be sure the cooperating teacher knows this so he/she instructs the class while you meet.
- maintain ongoing, honest feedback to allow the student teacher to adjust and perfect professional practices.
- relaying any concerns about your student and his/her success or lack of success to the Certification and Placement Specialist and Seminar Professor ASAP.

University Supervisors - Responsibilities

The responsibilities of the University Supervisor include:

- maintaining ongoing communication with the cooperating/mentor teacher for purposes of evaluating the progress and success of the student teacher. Try to learn of any challenges the student teacher is having and learning of the successes and strengths of the student prior to observations.
- reviewing the weekly journal reflections with the student teacher. Celebrate successes noted in the reflections, and guide the challenges noted.
- utilizing the Pennsylvania Statewide Evaluation Form for Student Professional Knowledge and Practice (PDE-430), *to complete a mid-term and a final evaluation*. When completing the PDE-430, be sure to place the numerical score in the overall rating box on each page. Also, be sure to complete the information at the bottom of the page, i.e., the signatures of the student teacher and yourself, and the dates. Please also be sure the words "Mid-term" or "Final" appear on the top of the front of the PDE-430. **Be sure to provide a copy of the Final PDE430 Evaluation to the student as he/she will need it to complete an assignment in Week 14 or 15 of EDU 565/ SPE 565.**
- utilizing the Lesson Observation Form included in this handbook for purposes of documenting student teacher observations (2) in addition to the mid-term and final observations.
- returning the observations to the Certification and Placement Specialist at the end of the placement, if there are no concerns.
- completing Exit Survey and returning it to the Certification and Placement Specialist.

University Supervisors - Responsibilities

The following must be returned to the Certification and Placement Specialist at the end of semester (refer to the specific date provided at the beginning of the semester):

- Mid-Term PDE-430 (around Week 7) & Final PDE-430 (by Week 13; submit at end of placement if there are no concerns).
- Lesson Observation Forms (2x); submit at the end of placement if there are no concerns.
- Communication Log University Supervisor, if there are no concerns,
- Recommended Final Grade Form
- Exit Survey
- All documentation from the cooperating/mentor teacher unless he/she wishes to submit him/herself.

University Supervisors - Forms

- Lesson Observation Form (University Supervisor) – 2x's
- PDE 430 – PA Statewide Evaluation Form for Student Professional Knowledge and Practice – 2x's (midterm and final)
- Communication Log for University Supervisors
- Recommended Final Grade Form
- University Supervisor Exit Survey – for each student teacher

Student Teachers - Contact Reference Guide for Unusual Circumstances

KEY = OPEN COMMUNICATION; keep your cooperating teacher, supervisor, seminar professor, and the Certification and Placement Specialist informed (cellphone, email, or text as appropriate/preferred) of **any change from the normal schedule.

Circumstance - Illness, family emergency, funeral

- **Contact or Action -** Call and email/text Cooperating/Mentor Teacher and University Supervisor

Circumstance - Change in daily school schedule: assembly, testing, class party, field trip

- **Contact or Action -** Call and email/text University Supervisor

Circumstance - In-Service Day, parent conferences, Back-To-School-Night

- **Contact or Action -** Call and email/text University Supervisor; attend with cooperating teacher

Circumstance - Faculty Job Action or Strike

- **Contact or Action -** Call and email/text Certification and Placement Specialist for direction

Circumstance - Inclement weather

- **Contact or Action -** Be sure your cooperating/mentor teacher knows how to contact you; listen to designated radio and/or TV reports to learn of delays and closings; monitor district's mass notification system

Important Contact Information:

- **Cooperating/Mentor Teacher Phone and email**
- **University Supervisor Phone and email**
- **Certification and Placement Specialist Phone and email**: Dr. Patrick McAleer, 215-646-7300, x21153; mcaleer.p@gmercyu.edu

Student Teachers - Forms

- Lesson Planning Framework (required for all lessons observed by University Supervisor)
- Student Teacher Self Assessment – 2x's (midterm and final)
- Videotaping Student Consent Form (for parents/guardians)
- Verification of Understanding and Agreement (Student Teaching Requirements)

PA CODE OF PROFESSIONAL PRACTICE AND CONDUCT FOR EDUCATORS

- https://www.pspc.education.pa.gov/Documents/Statutes%20Regs%20Forms/Code%20of%20Conduct.pdf
- **Referenced in the Handbook**
- **Recently refined to align with national ethics standards for educators (Model Code of Ethics for Educators - MCEE)**

GMERCYU
Gwynedd Mercy University

Teacher Certification - Requirements

Procedures leading to Instructional I Certification

- Bachelor's degree and completion of an approved teacher education program.
- Successfully complete the required examination(s) of the PECT or Praxis Series.
- Before graduation, a teacher certification application must be completed and submitted online via TIMS (Teacher Information Management System). The Certification and Placement Specialist will review all completed applications in TIMS and approve them accordingly.

Statutory Requirements - every professional employee certified to serve in the schools of Commonwealth of Pennsylvania shall: (1) be of good moral character; (2) show a physician's certificate indicating the applicant is neither mentally nor physically disqualified from successful performance of the duties of a teacher;(3) be at least 18 years of age; and (4) be a citizen of the United States. (Citizenship may be waived in the case of a resident foreign national holding an immigrant visa who declares in writing, to the State Secretary of Education, his/her intention of becoming a United States citizen.)

General Requirements

• In order to be recommended for certification, the student must receive a grade of **B** or better in student teaching experience and achieve the current minimum cumulative grade point average specified by the Pennsylvania Department of Education.

Levels of Certification

- **Instructional I (Provisional)** is issued for entry into a teaching position in the schools in the Commonwealth and is valid for six years of teaching in Pennsylvania. The applicant will have met all certification requirements and will have been recommended for certification by the Certification and Placement Specialist.
- **Instructional II (Permanent)** is a permanent certificate issued to an applicant who has completed a minimum of three years of satisfactory teaching in Pennsylvania on an Instructional I Certificate attested to by the chief administrator of the district/agency.
- **Note re: Act 48** - In addition, the applicant will have completed 24 semester credit hours of collegiate credit at an approved baccalaureate or advanced degree-granting institution subsequent to the conferring of the baccalaureate degree. These credits may be satisfied, in whole or in part, through in-service programs approved by the Secretary of Education. The applicant must successfully complete a PDE approved induction program to qualify for an Instructional II certificate.
    - •You must request that your Act 48 credits are submitted by the Registrar's Office; they will submit your course credits to PDE.

Videotaping of a Lesson

While you will receive continuous feedback from your cooperating/mentor teacher and your supervisor, another method of providing feedback regarding your instructional proficiencies is by way of videotaping a lesson. You are required to have one complete lesson, typically between 40 minutes to one hour, videotaped. You will plan this session with your cooperating/mentor teacher. **This lesson should be one that your University Supervisor does NOT observe in person**. The guardian letter following this page will be distributed to the guardians of the children who will be present during the videotaping of your lesson. Should any guardians opt that their child not be videotaped, you and your cooperating/mentor teacher may make arrangements to keep those students out of view of the camera. In most cases, the students will simply be seated behind the camera so that they do not miss instruction but are protected from being captured on film. Use the video as an honest opportunity for you to evaluate your teaching as per the Danielson Framework. If you are especially pleased with your video, it can become a wonderful artifact to share with prospective employers. You will share this video with your University Supervisor in order for him/her to evaluate it and count it as one of your observations.

**Adapted from Holy Family University's Student Teaching Handbook 2018-2019*

When planning for a videotaped lesson, contact Mr. Joe Denisco at denisco.j@gmercyu.edu to schedule the videotaping.

In viewing and analyzing the recordings, consider the following:

- **Content and Context:**
  - **Did you clearly introduce the day's goals and/or objectives at the beginning of the lesson?**
  - **Were your directions clear and concise?**
  - **Note the part of the lesson that could have been improved and why.**
  - **Suggest alternative strategies and their rationales.**
  - **What levels of questioning were used? Provide examples.**
  - **Were clues and prompts used to guide the students to correct responses?**
  - **Did you allow for flexibility in your lesson?**
- **Students' Responses:**
  - **How were the students actively involved in the lesson?**
  - **What indications are there that the students were motivated and engaged in the lesson?**
  - **What strategies did you use to motivate students who were not asking or answering questions?**
  - **How did you promote multicultural learning, gender fairness, and disability awareness?**
  - **What classroom management strategies did you use to keep students on task?**
  - **What strategies did you use to check for student understanding?**
- **Presentation Skills:**
  - **Did your voice have too little or too much volume?**
  - **Did you vary your voice to convey meaning?**
  - **Did you enunciate properly?**
  - **Did you use verbal filler?**
  - **Identify any annoying non-verbal mannerisms.**
  - **Identify contextual factors that influenced the lesson.**
  - **Did classroom management advance or impede student learning?**
  - **Were materials and equipment distributed in an organized and efficient manner?**
  - **Did you display enthusiasm?**

Using Your Own Classroom for Student Teaching ("Teacher of Record")

- Some students in the program are already teaching in settings that don't require them to be certified. This usually means a private school, Catholic school, charter school or a public school that has a critical shortage of teachers. In situations like this, students may use their own classroom as the setting for their student teaching and we send the site supervisors to your own classroom to observe.
- Students who want to use their own classroom for their student teaching may do so under the following conditions:
  - The school must be accredited by the State Department of Education
  - You must be the teacher of record (not an assistant or aide)
  - You must be teaching in the area of your certification
  - There are certain requirements regarding the structure of your teaching schedule (depends on subject and grade level).
  - The student teacher's principal assigns a cooperating ("mentor") teacher or administrator at the school. If a teacher, he or she must be certified in the area of your certification, have at least 3 years of satisfactory certified teaching experience in the respective area of certification, and at least one year of experience in the specific placement. If an administrator, administrator certification would suffice.
- If you teach in a nursery school, it makes sense to do your student teaching in your own classroom only if your ultimate goal is to teach PK. However, if you want to be an elementary school teacher, even a kindergarten teacher, you will gain much more valuable experience by doing your student teaching in an elementary school. Student teaching is a once in a lifetime opportunity to work alongside an experienced teacher. It's worth considering all of these things before making a decision about this.

Next Steps (prior to start of your placement)

- Through review of the Student Teaching Handbook.
- Connect with your Cooperating/Mentor Teacher and other important contacts at your placement
  - Share a copy of the Handbook and review the details of their role with them.
  - Also, make sure to share contact information for your Supervisor and Dr. McAleer with them. They can reach out to us at any time if they have questions or information they wish to share.
- Connect with your University supervisor to discuss expectations.
- Register for your seminar class if you have not yet done so.

Contact Dr. McAleer (Certification and Placement Specialist) - mcaleer.p@gmercyu.edu - if you have any questions or concerns.

Questions?

Comments?

Concerns?

Complaints?









Congratulations and Good Luck!

GMERCYU
Gwynedd Mercy University